

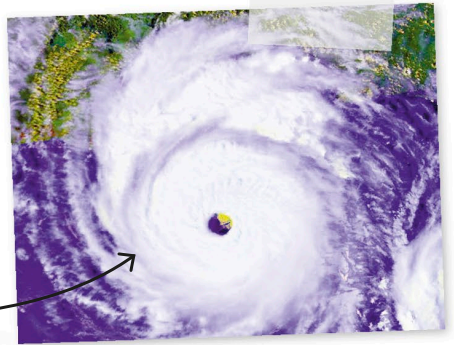
Superwinds

In summer, tropical places are hot and sunny. During the fall, the skies darken and storms sweep in from the sea, bringing fierce winds and lashing rain. These storms are called hurricanes, typhoons, or tropical cyclones, depending on where you live.

Tropical revolving storm

A hurricane starts when hot tropical sunshine stirs up moist air over the sea. It then whirls over the ocean in a giant spinning wheel of cloud, wind, and rain.

Picture of a hurricane taken from a satellite in space



Blown away

Howling hurricane winds can do terrible damage. On the coast, huge waves raised by the winds can swamp the shore.